

PROPRIETARY FEATURE-RICH SOFTWARE

Adobe InDesign

Platform: Windows and Mac

Price: Creative Cloud - ₹1,000/month (CS6 ₹51,597)

Adobe InDesign was the successor to Adobe PageMaker, which itself was originally acquired from Aldus in 1994. InDesign proved itself to be a battle hardened DTP software after it almost lost all ground to QuarkXPress.

Design professionals in the print media industry swear by InDesign and its capabilities. This loyalty is well earned, as InDesign is extremely refined and easy to use, making the learning curve short. Also, it's capable of laying out pages for more than just print media. It can help create layouts for digital media and ebooks as well.

InDesign has some really great features such as 'Alternate Design', which automatically adjusts the designed content for new dimensions – useful for when you have content that goes out on different platforms. Its 'Linked Content' feature saves you from the nightmare of making asset changes across different designs of a project.



A typical InDesign workspace

What this means is that if the content is linked across pages, then making a change to one page's content will change it across all the pages where it's linked. Another useful feature is 'Content Collector'. This is basically like a clipboard for content, where you can store objects that you intent to reuse.

QuarkXPress

Platform: Windows and Mac

Price: QuarkXPress 2015 - ₹54,255

QuarkXPress was first released in 1987 only for Mac and later in 1992 for Windows. It's the most widely used tool and at one point of time was the undisputed market leader.

QuarkXPress has been steadily regaining its ground in the industry after losing out to InDesign a few years ago. Since then, it has been innovating and bringing out useful features. Installation of QuarkXPress is pretty straightforward and simple. It comes with the Xenon Graphics Engine, and one of